Fennel will store better in the refrigerator if you remove the feathery fronds, but be sure to save a good handful for this soup as a garnish.

# fennel and apple soup

**SERVES** 4 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 30 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS




2 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
4 scallions, sliced
2 cloves garlic, chopped
1lb 5oz (600g) fennel (trimmed weight), coarsely chopped
1 celery heart with leaves, or 3 celery ribs, chopped
1 cooking apple, peeled, cored and coarsely chopped
sea salt
3¼ cups vegetable stock
fennel fronds, to serve

1 Heat the oil in a large pan over medium heat and add the scallions. Soften for 3 minutes, then add the garlic. Cook for 1–2 minutes until fragrant, then add the fennel, celery, and apple with a little salt. Stir, cover, and sweat for 10 minutes, stirring frequently.

2 Pour in the stock and bring to a boil. Simmer for 15 minutes, until the fennel is tender. Cool briefly, then purée with a hand blender. Taste and adjust the seasoning. Serve hot, or allow to cool, chill for several hours, and serve cold. Serve each bowl scattered with torn fennel fronds.



**FENNEL**
In the market, look for firm, unblemished bulbs that are heavy for their size with bright green fronds. If you are considering growing your own, keep in mind that fennel thrives in warm conditions.